JAMES MCCALLUM

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a mid-level full stack engineer based in Glasgow with four years of hands-on experience building web applications using modern JavaScript frameworks and cloud infrastructure. I've worked across early-stage startups and established tech companies, developing everything from customer-facing features to backend systems handling thousands of daily requests. I'm particularly interested in writing clean, maintainable code and mentoring junior developers when the opportunity arises. I enjoy the challenge of balancing quick delivery with long-term code quality.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

TechCore Solutions

Previously known as Vertex Digital Labs

Glasgow, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Designed and implemented a real-time notification system serving over 50,000 active users, reducing message delivery latency from 8 seconds to under 500ms through Redis caching and WebSocket optimization.

Led the migration of a legacy monolithic application to microservices architecture using Docker and Kubernetes, improving deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases.

Mentored two junior developers on REST API design patterns and React best practices, conducting weekly code reviews and pairing sessions.

Implemented comprehensive end-to-end testing suite using Cypress and Jest, increasing test coverage from 32% to 78% and reducing production bugs by approximately 45%.

Full Stack Developer

Innovate Labs Ltd

innovatelabs.io

Edinburgh, United Kingdom

July 2021 - February 2023

Developed full-stack features for a SaaS project management platform using React, Node.js, and PostgreSQL, directly supporting customer acquisition that grew from 200 to 2,800 active users.

Optimized database queries and introduced query caching strategies, reducing average API response times by 60% and lowering database load by 35%.

Collaborated with product and design teams to implement responsive UI components, ensuring pixel-perfect accuracy across mobile and desktop devices.

Set up continuous integration pipelines using GitHub Actions, automating testing and deployment processes and reducing manual deployment time from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Junior Full Stack Developer

Brightwave Technologies

brightwavetech.net

Glasgow, United Kingdom

September 2019 - June 2021

Built and maintained internal tools and customer-facing web applications using Vue.js and Python Flask, supporting operations for 15+ enterprise clients.

Troubleshot production issues and implemented fixes within 2-4 hours of incident reports, maintaining 99.2% uptime for critical systems.

Wrote documentation for API endpoints and deployment procedures, creating onboarding materials that reduced new developer setup time from 3 days to 1 day.

Participated in daily standups and bi-weekly sprint planning, learning Agile methodologies and gaining experience with ticket-driven development workflows.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Glasgow

Glasgow, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2019

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, Python, SQL, HTML5, CSS3, TypeScript

Frontend: React, Vue.js, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Material-UI, Responsive Design

Backend: Node.js, Express.js, Flask, RESTful API Design, GraphQL basics

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Database Optimization

DevOps and Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, AWS (EC2, S3, RDS), GitHub Actions, CI/CD pipelines, Linux Administration

Testing: Jest, Cypress, Mocha, Unit Testing, Integration Testing

Tools and Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab, Jira, npm, Webpack, Postman

OTHER

Public GitHub Repositories:

TaskRunner - Task scheduling and monitoring application built with Node.js and React. Implements background job queues and real-time progress tracking.

EcommercePlatform - Full-stack e-commerce system with product management, user authentication, and Stripe payment integration.

DataVisualizationDashboard - Interactive dashboard for displaying analytics data using D3.js and Express.js backend.

APIDocGenerator - Automated documentation generator for REST APIs written in Python Flask with customizable templates.

Certifications: AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2022)